

★ STARBLAST ★

Player's Manual

A fast-paced top-down space shooter built with raylib and C. Pilot your fighter through 5 increasingly intense waves of alien enemies, dodge incoming fire, and obliterate everything in your path.

1. Game Overview

STARBLAST is a single-player arcade shooter. You control a sleek fighter ship at the bottom of the screen. Waves of enemy craft descend from the top, shooting back at you. Clear all 5 waves to win. Lose all 3 lives and it's game over.

2. Controls

Key(s)	Action
W / ↑	Move Up
S / ↓	Move Down
A / ←	Move Left
D / →	Move Right
SPACE / Z	Fire Laser
P / ESC	Pause / Unpause
ENTER	Confirm (menus)

3. HUD – Heads-Up Display

HP Bar (top-left)

Shows your current health. Green = healthy, yellow = caution, red = critical. You start with 100 HP. Each enemy bullet deals 20 damage; ramming an enemy deals 40.

Lives (below HP bar)

Small ship icons represent extra lives (you start with 3). When HP reaches 0 you lose a life and respawn with 2.5 seconds of invincibility.

Score (top-centre)

Accumulates points for each enemy destroyed: Scout = 50 pts, Tank = 150 pts, Boss = 500 pts.

Wave counter (top-right)

Displays the current wave number (1–5). A 'WAVE CLEAR!' banner appears between waves.

4. Enemy Types

Type	Appearance	HP	Fire Rate	Score	Behaviour
Scout	Small red triangle	20+	Medium	50	Drifts side to side; aims loosely at player
Tank	Purple rectangle	60+	Slow	150	Slower movement; higher durability
Boss	Large gold ship	200+	Rapid (3-spread)	500	Drifts toward player; appears from Wave 3+

Note: HP and fire-rate scale with wave number — later waves are harder!

5. Wave Progression

There are 5 waves in total. Each wave spawns more enemies with higher stats:

Wave	Enemies	Contains Boss?	Difficulty
1	5	No	Easy — learn the controls
2	8	No	Medium — more enemies, faster shots
3	11	Yes	Hard — Boss appears for first time
4	14	Yes	Very Hard — faster everything
5	17	Yes	Final wave — maximum intensity

6. Tips & Strategy

Stay mobile: Never stop moving. A stationary ship is an easy target.

Prioritise the Boss: The Boss fires 3-way spread shots and drifts toward you. Take it out early to reduce pressure.

Hold fire on Tanks: Tanks have lots of HP. Land every shot rather than spraying; your bullets are unlimited but enemies shoot while alive.

Use the full width: Keep your horizontal range wide to dodge incoming fire from multiple enemies at once.

Invincibility window: After taking a hit you get ~1.5 seconds of mercy invincibility — use this to reposition.

Score multiplier tip: Bosses are worth 500 points — focus on clearing them to maximise your final score.

7. Victory & Game Over

YOU WIN — Clear all 5 waves with at least 1 life remaining. Your total score is displayed on the victory screen.

GAME OVER — Lose all 3 lives before clearing wave 5. Press ENTER to retry from wave 1, or ESC to return to the main menu.

8. Building & Running

Requirements: MSYS2 MinGW64 UCRT with raylib installed.

Install raylib once:

```
pacman -S mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-raylib
```

Then build and run:

```
make # compiles to bin/starblast.exe  
make run # builds + launches  
make clean # removes build artefacts
```